



ARMISTICE

Every Move Counts

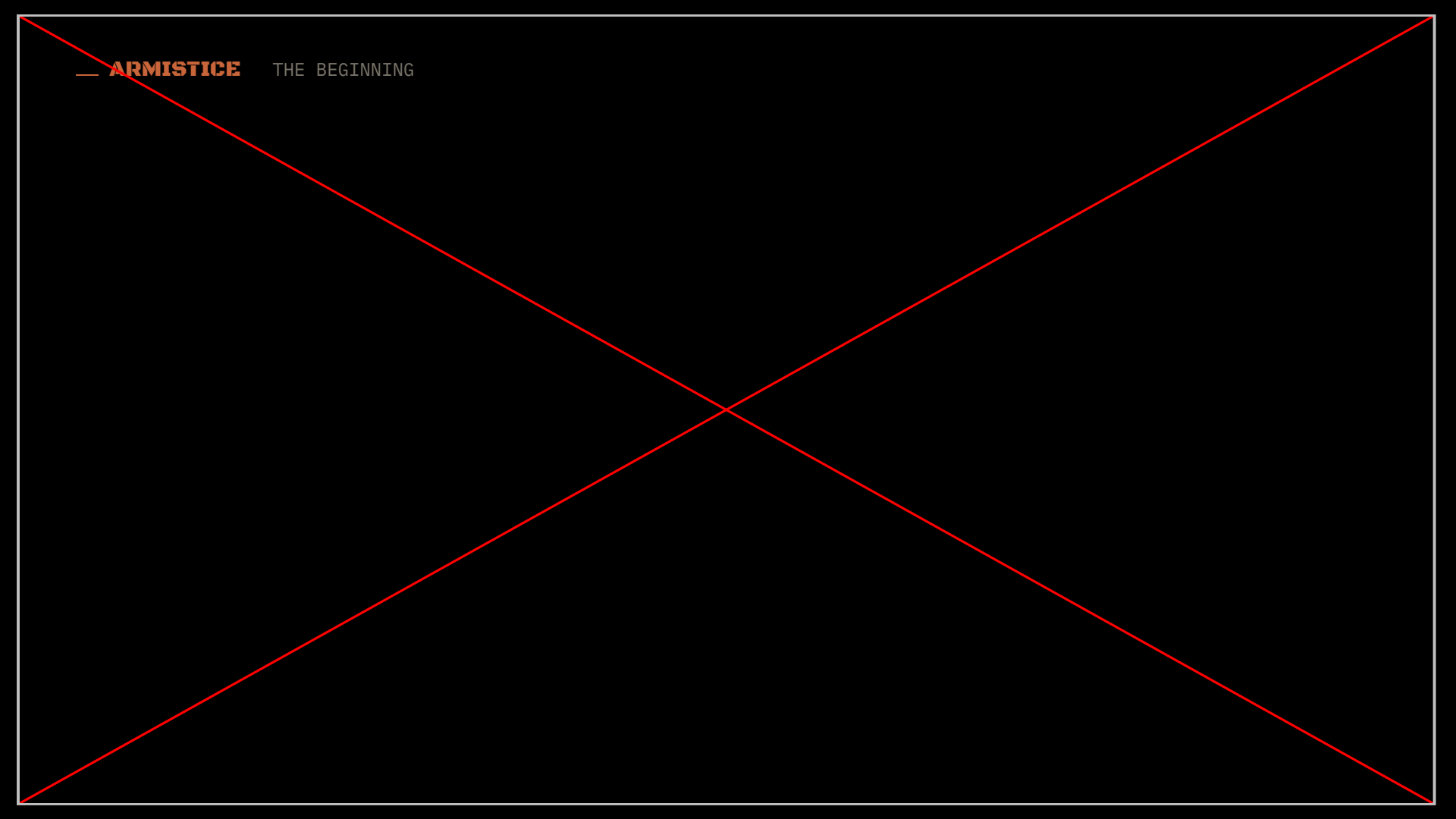
4 PLAYERS // TACTICAL // ITERATED DILEMMA

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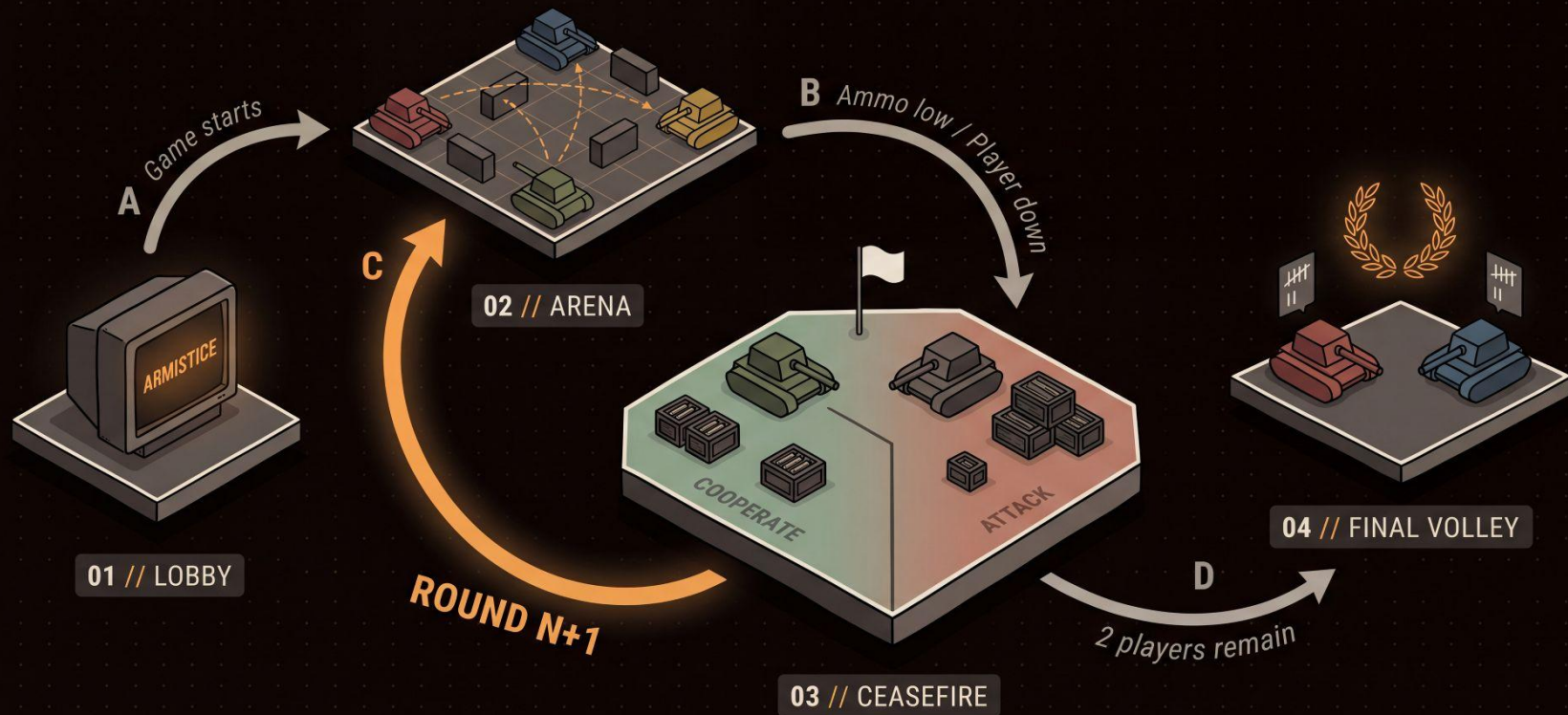
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— **ARMISTICE** THE BEGINNING

A dark blue square with a thin white border. Two red diagonal lines cross each other in the center, forming a large 'X' that divides the square into four triangles. The lines extend from the corners of the square towards the center.

Game Flow



Prisoner's Dilemma

FROM TWO PRISONERS TO FOUR TANKS · THE RESEARCH FOUNDATION

01 THE CLASSIC

PRISONER'S DILEMMA · EST. 1950

Two suspects. Each picks SILENCE or BETRAY. Self-interest pushes both to defect — yet mutual cooperation is the winning move.

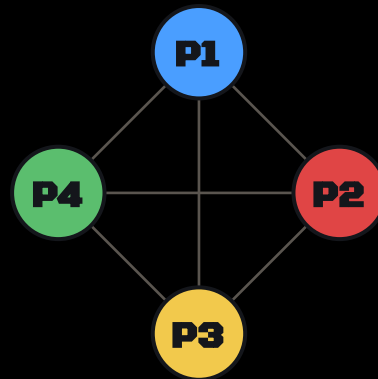
		PLAYER B →	
		COOPERATE	DEFECT
↓ PLAYER A	COOPERATE	3 / 3 MUTUAL WIN	0 / 5 SUCKER
	DEFECT	5 / 0 TEMPTATION	1 / 1 MUTUAL LOSS

EQUILIBRIUM: BOTH DEFECT. OPTIMUM: BOTH COOPERATE.

02 THE EXPERIMENT

ARMISTICE · 4 PLAYERS · ITERATED

Four tanks, every round, vote COOPERATE or ATTACK at once. Reputations form, alliances drift, betrayals echo.



SHIFTING ALLIANCES

ITERATED MEMORY

EMERGENT COALITIONS

— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— **ARMISTICE** In the field

PLAYTEST



— ARMISTICE THE BEGINNING

TACTICAL MAP | SECTOR X-14 | ACTIVE
STATUS: MONITORING | GRID: 67
SYS: ACTIVE
COMM_LINK: (III...)

Tanks 3
Bullets 3

Ceasefire in: 3s



Tanks 3
Bullets 3

UNITS DETECTED: 21 | RANGE: WIDE
OBJECTIVES: 03 | ALERT: NONE
ZOOM: (II)
SCANNING: (IIIIII)

Tanks 3
Bullets 3

Tanks 3
Bullets 3

— ARMISTICE THE BEGINNING

TACTICAL MAP | SECTOR X-14 | ACTIVE
STATUS: MONITORING | GRID: 67
SYS: ACTIVE
COMM_LINK: (III...)

Tanks **2**
Bullets **0**

Press Y to call Ceasefire

Tanks **3**
Bullets **2**

UNITS DETECTED: 21 | RANGE: WIDE
OBJECTIVES: 03 | ALERT: NONE
ZOOM: (II)
SCANNING: (IIIIII)

Tanks **3**
Bullets **2**

Tanks **3**
Bullets **3**





— **ARMISTICE** THE BEGINNING



— ARMISTICE THE BEGINNING

TACTICAL MAP | SECTOR X-14 | ACTIVE
STATUS: MONITORING | GRID: 07
SYS: ACTIVE
COMM_LINK: (III...)

Press Y to call Ceasefire

Tanks 2
Bullets 0



UNITS DETECTED: 21 | RANGE: WIDE
OBJECTIVES: 03 | ALERT: NONE
ZOOM: (III...)
SCANNING: (IIIIII...)

Tanks 2
Bullets 3

Tanks 3
Bullets 6

DEMO

Hypothesis 1

More players will choose to attack to secure bullets

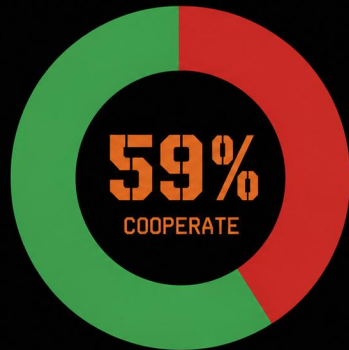
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↓ PLAYER A	COOPERATE	3 / 3 MUTUAL WIN	0 / 5 SUCKER
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EQUILIBRIUM: BOTH DEFECT.

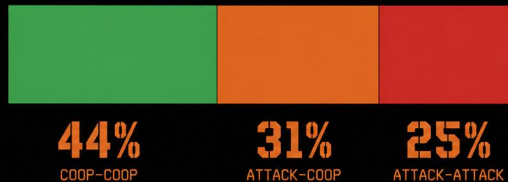
OPTIMUM: BOTH COOPERATE.

Tendency to Cooperate with physical cards

INTENT - 64 INDIVIDUAL DECISIONS



OUTCOME - 32 PAIRED INTERACTIONS



Tendency to **Attack** with virtual experience

- Playing with physical cards felt more “real”
 - No time limit, more talking
 - Looking at each other, compared to the screen
- Switch from your true morals to your video game morals
- Easier to trick on the controller



Hypothesis 2

Players who choose to cooperate during a ceasefire will
also cooperate in combat.

Players fight the closet tank



Next Steps

- Choose your team menu + tank naming
- Power ups
 - Different bullet shots
 - Larger bullets (missiles)
- Balance ceasefire rewards
- Different maps
 - Changing terrain
- Different “ceasefires”
 - How else could we simulate a prisoners dilemma without it being explicit?

Thank you!

APPENDIX

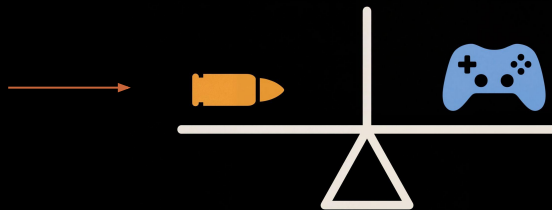
Playtest Findings

+ THE Positive Highlights of the Gameplay



SOCIAL CORE LOOP IS ENGAGING

Cooperate/Attack voting drives real table-talk, alliances, and loud betrayals. Players stayed engaged throughout the gameplay.



AMMO ECONOMY HAS REAL STAKES

Tying ammo to the dilemma forces a balance in negotiation and attacking strategies.

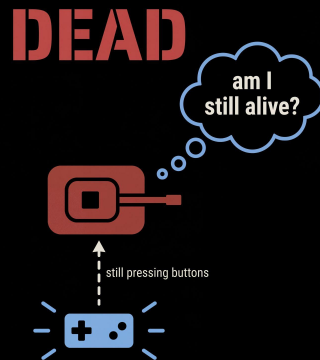
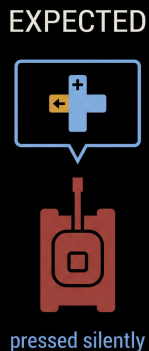


EMERGENT PLAYSTYLES

Players naturally diverged into aggressive, turtle, and pacifist strategies with zero prompting.

Playtest Findings

THE Negative Highlights of the Gameplay

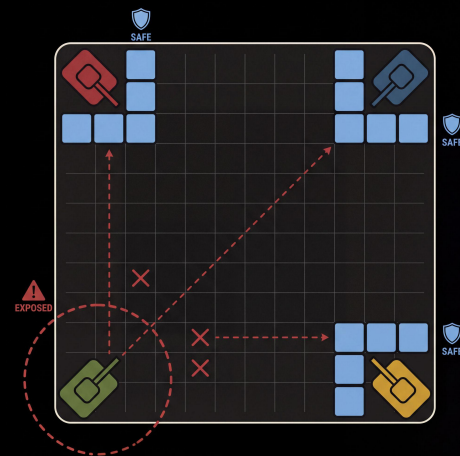


VOTING PHASE IS CURRENTLY ANALOG

Manual 3-2-1 countdowns, no secrecy, unlimited talk time kills tension.

NO FEEDBACK LOOPS

No death VFX/SFX, no ceasefire cue. Betrayal changes a number but the effect is not visual.



MAP IS UNBALANCED

Green spawn is wide open while others get immediate cover.

Statement

Armistice is a four-player tank game that examines how behavioral dynamics shape decision-making under conflict. Between rounds of combat, players enter a ceasefire phase structured around an iterated Prisoner's Dilemma — cooperate to share resources, or defect to claim more at another's expense. Each decision compounds. Alliances built in one round become leverage or liability in the next, and patterns of trust, retaliation, and self-interest emerge from the players themselves rather than from the system.

By placing strategic incentives in direct tension with social ones, Armistice asks how players reason about cooperation when trust carries a measurable cost — and what those choices reveal about decision-making under pressure.

Game Design



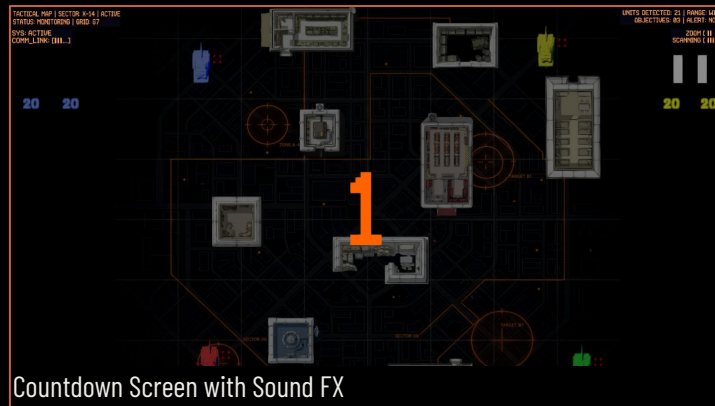
Home Screen with Music and Sound FX on Button Click

The game design is focused on creating a tactical battle like feeling from the home screen and all transition screens. The sound effects like “shots fired” for button clicks and the countdown aim to create anticipation and provide time for players to focus and get ready when the game launches.

The workflow used for creating these include some AI generation imagery with enhancements in Illustrator and Photoshop. The syncing and calibration was handled using Unity.



Loading Screen



Countdown Screen with Sound FX

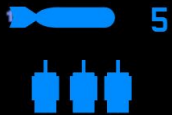
Game Design : The Arena

The arena design has been inspired by HUD systems typically seen on battle machines engaged in war. The same top down view seen by radar systems has been implemented to make 4 player gameplay easy and engaging with all players having the same top-down view to look at.

The arena background has some small elements on the top right and left with small text enhancing the the feel of the radar systems aesthetic. The game intentionally has been made to follow a dark theme to make other elements visible. In addition, the obstacles were design to add more elements like bunkers, military supply station aesthetics to the arena.



UI Design

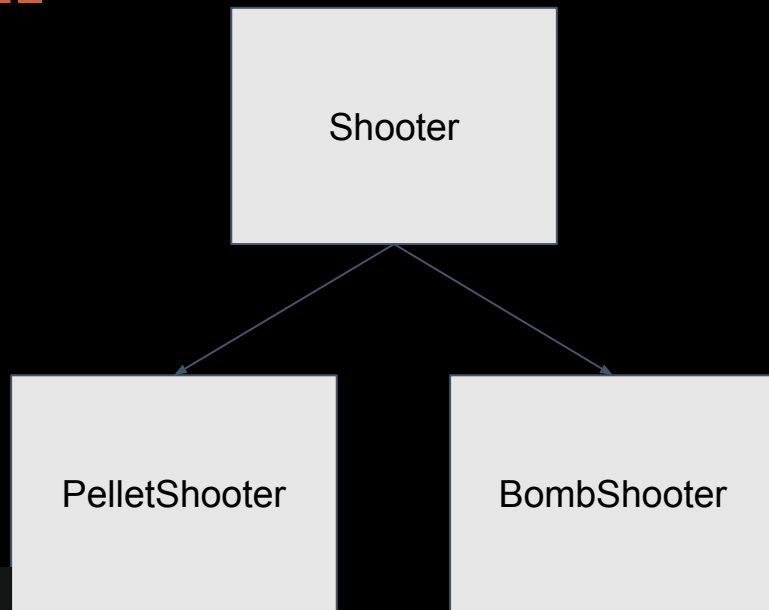


Shooting Mechanism

- **Shooter base class**
 - Implements shared logic
 - Derived classes add semantic meaning
- Add Projectile component to any GameObject
- GetComponent<PelletShooter>()

```
class PelletShooter : Shooter { }
```

```
public void AddPellet(playerController player)
{
    player.GetComponentInParent<PelletShooter>()?.Increment();
}
```



Player Movement

- Sprite needs to rotate with movement
- Tanks move slowly
- Joystick directs the rotation angle

```
float angle = Mathf.Atan2(movementInput.y, movementInput.x) * Mathf.Rad2Deg - 90f;  
Quaternion targetRotation = Quaternion.Euler(0f, 0f, angle);  
transform.rotation = Quaternion.RotateTowards(transform.rotation, targetRotation, rotationSpeed * Time.fixedDeltaTime);
```

Success with UnityEvents

```
public class ColliderEvent : UnityEvent<Collider2D> { }
```

0 references | ⓘ Unity Script (2 asset references)

```
public class TriggerBridge : MonoBehaviour  
{
```

1 reference | ⓘ Unity Serialized Field

```
    public ColliderEvent OnEntry;
```

0 references | ⓘ Unity Message

```
    private void OnTriggerEnter2D(Collider2D other)  
    {  
        OnEntry?.Invoke(other);  
    }  
}
```

✓ Trigger Bridge (Script)

Script

TriggerBridge

On Entry (Collider2D)



Runtime Only



Health.OnHit



Tank (Health)

